available in nature besides producing richer and better products from agricultural, animal and forest produce. The countries and people that transitioned from the agricultural economy or built a new economy based on industrial products prospered in the industrial age, which started sometime in the late eighteenth century and blossomed in the twentieth century.

For much of the nineteenth and twentieth century, India and China resisted industrial adoption and fell behind. Colonization worsened the matter. By the middle of the twentieth century, they were among the poorest countries in the world. China jumped on the industrial bandwagon in the late 1970s and soon became the factory of the world. India was not as enterprising and aggressive in industrializing the country. As a result, the Industrial Revolution generated only mediocre returns for the country.

Europe, North America and Japan, who were the leaders in the Industrial Revolution, slowed down from the second half of the twentieth century and industrial leadership passed on to China, South Korea, South-east Asia and a few other countries. Europe and Japan, the industrial powers of the twentieth century, are in decline now. North America has moved on to the next economic revolution: the digital revolution.

Using digital technologies and artificial intelligence (AI), the digital revolution has expanded the capability of the human mind and ability to deliver services. People and nations who are mastering and producing digital technologies are forging ahead and, in times to come, will be leaders and winners in the economic sweepstakes. The US, China, Taiwan and a few other countries seem to have forged ahead in the digital era as well. India has a chance to be at the forefront of the full-scale digital revolution, instead of only being a leader in IT services.

Historical performance is no guarantee or even a necessary guide for future prosperity. Countries that master the digital revolution and build their economies using this comparative advantage will lead the next major spurt